

19. Rolling home

Solo:

Call all hands to man the capstan
See the cable flaked down clear
Heave away and with a will boys
For Ol' England we will steer
And we'll sing in joyful chorus
In the watches of the night
And we'll sight the shores of England
When the grey dawn brings the light

Refrein:

Rolling home, rolling home
Rolling home across the sea
Rolling home to dear Ol' England
Rolling home dear land to thee

Solo:

Many thousand miles behind us
Many thousand miles before
Ancient ocean waves to wa(e)ft us
To the well remembered shore
Cheer up Jack, bright smiles await you
from the fairest of the fair
And her loving eyes will greet you
With kind welcomes everywhere

Refrein:

Rolling home, rolling home
Rolling home across the sea
Rolling home to dear Ol' England
Rolling home dear land to thee

Solo:

Eastward, eastward, ever eastward
To the rising of the sun
We have steered ever eastward
Since our voyage has begun
Off Cape Horn on a winter's morning
Setting sails in ice and snow
You could hear the Shellbacks calling:
"Hoist away and let her go"

Refrein:

Rolling home, rolling home
Rolling home across the sea
Rolling home to dear Ol' England
Rolling home dear land to thee